

15 Jul 2026 09:33:51 ET | 15 pages

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

In-line 2Q26E expected; Addressing the 2Q focus points

CITI'S TAKE

We expect PharmaResearch (PR) to report in-line 2Q results, driven by solid medical device and cosmetic exports growth. We also address focus points as we head into 2Q26 earnings call. Discrepancy likely increased between customs exports data vs. medical device exports, yet we continue to have a positive view on the stock. Reiterate Buy.

In-line 2Q expected — We expect PharmaResearch (PR) to report well in-line 2Q26E results with sales of W168bn (+20% YoY) and OP of W67bn (+20% YoY). We view 2Q topline growth drivers should likely be 1) medical device export sales of W28bn (+14% YoY) as PR successfully expands to western EU regions and 2) cosmetic sales of W52bn (+70% YoY) on back of strong demand in both domestic & overseas sales in addition to W4bn worth of pull-forwarded demand from Eastern EU regions (ahead of implementations of revised EU cosmetic importing regulations). We expect OP margin to reach 40% in 2Q26 (marginal increase by 60bps QoQ) due to unfavorable topline mix from cosmetics and increased marketing expenses.

Focus points into 2Q results call — We believe following points should be addressed heading into 2Q print - 1) medical device exports growth momentum in 2H26E (we currently estimate similar amounts to western EU QoQ in 3Q26E); 2) cosmetics growth outlook in overseas and 3) US ODM acquisition: capex investment plan / margin outlook (in terms of short-term margin dilution from loss-making acquisition, longer-term margin accretion from logistics improvement)

Discrepancy increases, yet positive — Discrepancy between export data (2Q26 W48bn to ex-US global markets from Gangneung province) vs. our estimates of the medical device exports (2Q26E W28bn) is seemingly increasing in recent quarters as cosmetic sales to overseas markets increase amid inefficient logistics structure. However, we continue to have a positive view on PR given we see the customs data as a proxy for the strong underlying demand in both cosmetics and medical device.

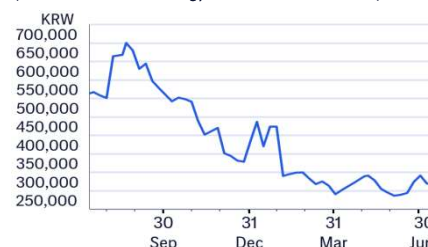
Maintain TP — We fine-tune our FY26-28E NP estimates by less than 2%. Reiterate Buy with TP of W480k.

Buy

Price (15 Jul 26 15:45)	W327,500
Target price	W480,000
Expected share price return	46.6%
Expected dividend yield	1.6%
Expected total return	48.1%
Market Cap	W3,402,610M
	US\$2,247M

Price Performance

(RIC: 214450.KQ, BB: 214450 KS)


Heejin Lim^{AC}

Earnings Summary

Year to 31 Dec	Net Profit (WB)	Diluted EPS (W)	EPS growth (%)	P/E (x)	P/B (x)	ROE (%)	Yield (%)
2024A	92	8,838	17.9	37.1	6.4	18.9	0.3
2025A	165	15,801	78.8	20.7	4.9	26.9	1.1
2026E	215	18,599	17.7	17.6	3.9	27.6	1.6
2027E	262	22,622	21.6	14.5	3.1	26.8	1.9
2028E	310	26,798	18.5	12.2	2.6	25.7	2.3

Source: Powered by dataCentral

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

214450.KQ: Fiscal year end 31-Dec						Price: W327,500; TP: W480,000; Market Cap: W3,402,610m; Recomm: Buy					
Profit & Loss (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	350	536	681	820	956	PE (x)	37.1	20.7	17.6	14.5	12.2
Cost of sales	-99	-125	-159	-195	-227	PB (x)	6.4	4.9	3.9	3.1	2.6
Gross profit	251	411	523	625	729	EV/EBITDA (x)	22.7	12.5	9.5	7.3	6.0
Gross Margin (%)	71.8	76.7	76.7	76.3	76.2	FCF yield (%)	3.0	4.5	3.4	6.0	7.3
EBITDA (Adj)	135	230	290	353	404	Dividend yield (%)	0.3	1.1	1.6	1.9	2.3
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	38.6	42.9	42.5	43.1	42.2	Payout ratio (%)	12	23	28	28	28
Depreciation	-9	-10	-9	-10	-11	ROE (%)	18.9	26.9	27.6	26.8	25.7
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0	Cashflow (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
EBIT (Adj)	126	214	273	333	392	EBITDA	135	224	282	343	404
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	36.0	40.0	40.1	40.7	41.1	Working capital	0	-25	-25	-32	-30
Net interest	-16	9	12	13	18	Other	3	-17	-102	-52	-59
Associates	6	0	0	0	0	Operating cashflow	138	183	154	260	315
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	0	-7	0	0	0	Capex	-36	-30	-24	-33	-38
Pre-tax profit	116	217	285	346	410	Net acq/disposals	-170	-113	-7	-9	-12
Tax	-27	-48	-65	-80	-94	Other	-20	-13	0	0	0
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	3	-3	-4	-5	-6	Investing cashflow	-226	-156	-31	-42	-50
Reported net profit	92	165	215	262	310	Dividends paid	-10	-12	-39	-54	-65
Net Margin (%)	26.3	30.8	31.6	31.9	32.4	Financing cashflow	183	-15	-39	-54	-65
Core NPAT	92	165	215	262	310	Net change in cash	96	10	85	164	200
Per share data	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	Free cashflow to s/holders	102	153	130	227	277
Reported EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,599	22,622	26,798						
Core EPS (W)	8,838	15,801	18,599	22,622	26,798						
DPS (W)	1,100	3,700	5,180	6,300	7,460						
CFPS (W)	13,262	17,527	13,314	22,454	27,240						
FCFPS (W)	9,765	14,683	11,252	19,619	23,934						
BVPS (W)	51,323	66,346	83,720	104,205	128,305						
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	10.4	10.5	10.4	10.4	10.4						
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	10.4	10.5	11.6	11.6	11.6						
Growth rates	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Sales revenue (%)	34.1	53.2	27.1	20.3	16.6						
EBIT (Adj) (%)	36.6	70.1	27.4	22.1	17.7						
Core NPAT (%)	20.2	79.4	30.3	21.6	18.5						
Core EPS (%)	17.9	78.8	17.7	21.6	18.5						
Balance Sheet (Wb)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E						
Cash & cash equiv.	452	620	766	930	1,130						
Accounts receivables	43	52	60	73	85						
Inventory	57	83	104	127	148						
Net fixed & other tangibles	200	235	247	265	287						
Goodwill & intangibles	33	31	33	37	43						
Financial & other assets	70	22	22	22	22						
Total assets	856	1,044	1,233	1,455	1,715						
Accounts payable	11	11	14	18	21						
Short-term debt	9	8	8	8	8						
Long-term debt	1	0	0	0	0						
Provisions & other liab	265	300	302	302	302						
Total liabilities	286	320	325	328	332						
Shareholders' equity	539	689	870	1,083	1,333						
Minority interests	30	35	39	44	49						
Total equity	569	724	908	1,126	1,383						
Net debt (Adj)	-442	-612	-757	-921	-1,121						
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-77.6	-84.5	-83.3	-81.8	-81.1						
For definitions of the items in this table, please click here .											

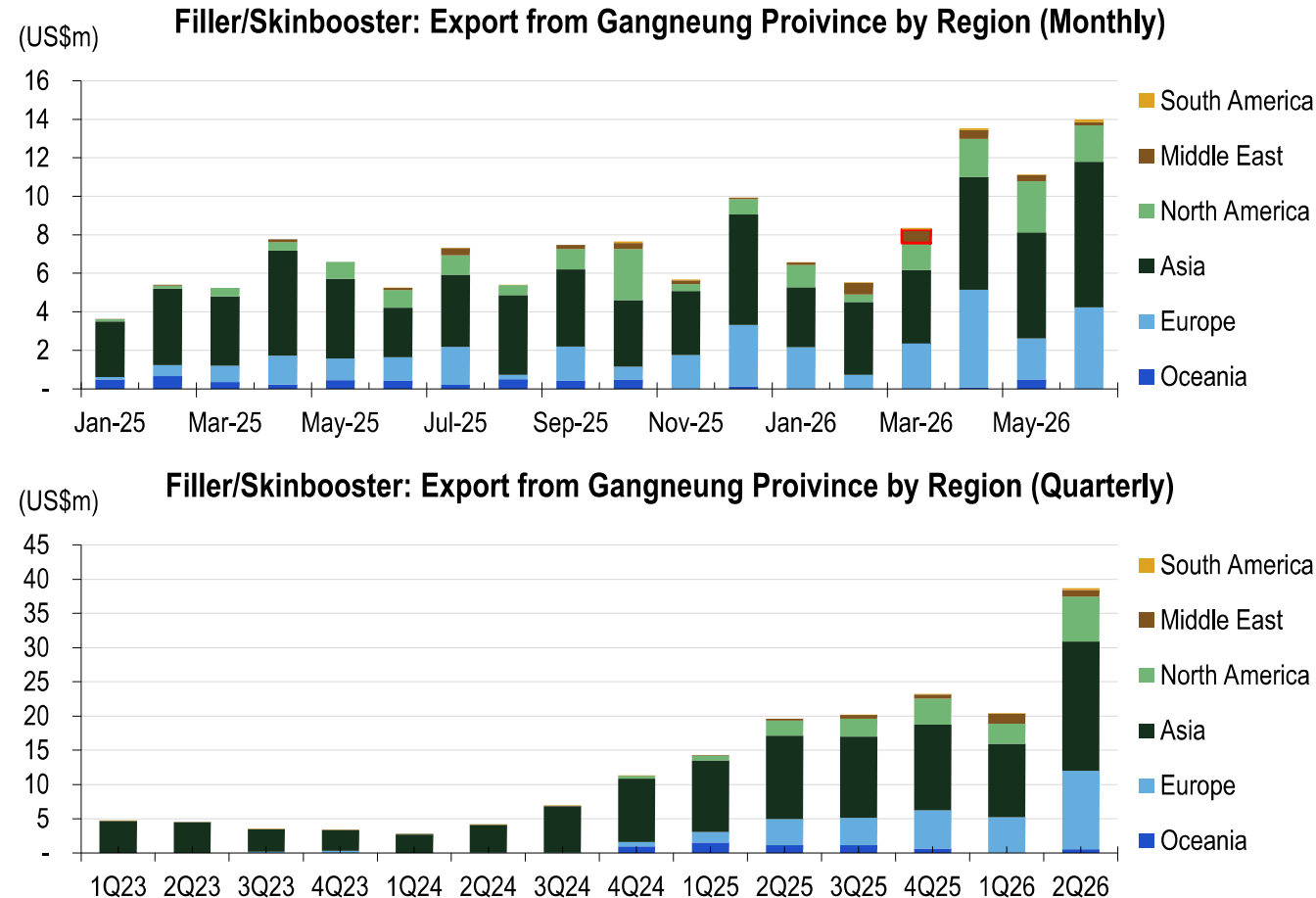
Figure 1. PR: 2Q26E Results Preview

(Wbn)	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26E	YoY	QoQ	2Q26E Cons	Diff
Revenue	141	135	143	146	168	20%	15%	164	3%
YoY	69%	52%	39%	25%	20%				
1) By segment									
Medical device (Skinbooster)	85	77	83	80	91	7%	14%		
Cosmetics	31	35	38	42	52	70%	24%		
Pharmaceuticals	20	22	23	21	22	9%	4%		
Others	4	2	(1)	3	3	-30%	3%		
2) By geography									
Domestic	90	85	85	88	96	6%	9%		
Exports	51	50	58	58	73	43%	25%		
Asia	35	33	37	39	39	12%	-1%		
> China	18	18	18						
> Asia ex-China	16	15	19						
EU/Oceania	7	7	12	10	18	152%	88%		
America	8	10	9	7	13	58%	72%		
Others	1	1	1	2	2	125%	8%		
Operating profit	56	62	52	57	67	20%	17%	65	2%
OPM	40%	46%	36%	39%	40%			40%	
YoY	82%	77%	54%	28%	20%				
RP	56	65	50	68	70	25%	3%	69	1%
Ex-minority NP	47	49	33	48	53	11%	11%	56	-5%

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Figure 2. Customs Export by Region from Gangneung Province

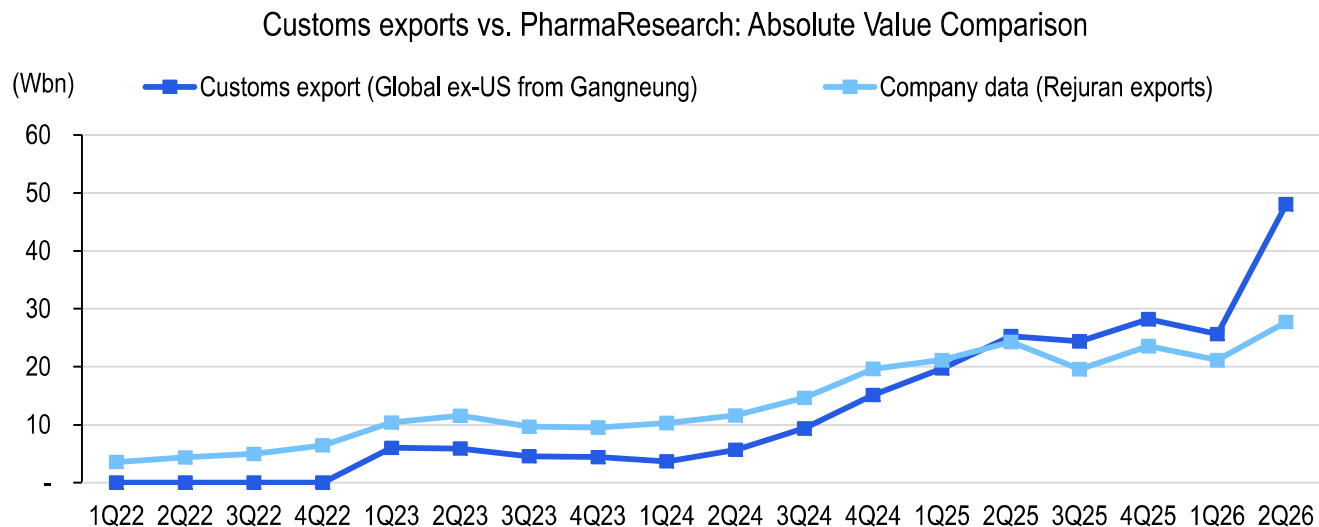


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Note: HS code 3304.99.9000 (filler & other category)

Source: Citi Research, Korea Customs

Figure 3. Customs export vs. company data: absolute value comparison



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Note: HS code 3304.99.9000 (filler & other category), Customs data excludes US; Customs export in US\$mn translated to KRW at an average FX rate of 1,494 won in 2Q26

Source: Citi Research, Korea Customs

Figure 4. PR: Earnings Revision

(W bn, %)	New			Old			%		
	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	681	820	956	674	818	961	1%	0%	-1%
OP	273	333	392	267	329	397	2%	1%	-1%
RP	285	346	410	279	342	414	2%	1%	-1%
NP	215	262	310	213	259	313	1%	1%	-1%
OPM	40.1%	40.7%	41.1%	39.7%	40.3%	41.3%	0.4%pt	0.4%pt	-0.2%pt
RPM	41.8%	42.2%	42.9%	41.4%	41.8%	43.1%	0.4%pt	0.4%pt	-0.2%pt
NPM	31.6%	31.9%	32.4%	31.6%	31.6%	32.6%	0.0%pt	0.3%pt	-0.1%pt

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, Bloomberg

Bull/Bear: PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

W 570,000
▲74% Upside

W 480,000
▲47% Upside

W 300,000
▼8.4% Downside



Spread 82pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 15 Jul 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Stronger-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Higher-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Better cost control management leading to higher margin profile

BASE Assumptions

- Medical device sales growth of +20% YoY in FY26E
- Cosmetics sales growth of +53% YoY in FY26E
- OP margin of 40% in FY26E

BEAR Assumptions

- Weaker-than-expected sales growth in medical device
- Lower-than-expected demand for cosmetics
- Less effective cost control management leading to lower margin profile

PharmaResearch

Company description

PharmaResearch, founded in 2001, is a leading South Korean medical aesthetics/pharmaceutical company specializing in regenerative materials based on polynucleotide (PN)/polydeoxyribonucleotide (PDRN) ingredients. Its major products include facial injectable medical device Rejuran and arthritis joint cavity injection product Conjuran, followed by derivative value-added cosmetic products under the same Rejuran brand.

Investment strategy

We have a Buy rating on PharmaResearch, a leading company in the global medical aesthetics sector, underpinned by its regenerative PN/PDRN skin booster. Our investment thesis assumes: 1) solid topline growth potential in the domestic market from inbound tourism; 2) increasing penetration in EU/US markets backed by rising brand recognition; and 3) portfolio expansion into toxin, new collagen booster, and EBD providing additional catalysts.

Valuation

Our target price of W480k is based on a P/E methodology. We expect 2026 to be the year when PR's new growth drivers are likely to be fully reflected, underpinned by: 1) full reflection of EU market expansion; 2) increase in penetration among medspas; and 3) EBD and PLLA skin booster potentially entering the global market following their scheduled introduction in Korea within 2025. We believe our target 2026E P/E multiple of 26x is justified, given: 1) brand originality, which many local peers seem to lack, supporting competitiveness and longer product lifecycle; 2) stronger growth potential relative to top-tier peer's injectable aesthetics sales outlook; and 3) earnings upside risk from skinbooster TAM opportunities. Our target multiple is set at a 25% premium to PR's broader peer group given the above reasons.

Risks

Key downside risks that could impede the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) change in trend (or increase in competition) within skin boosters; 2) brand reputation risk in case of medical incidents; 3) rise of generics post-Rejuran's patent expiry after 2030E; and 4) prolonged weak growth in overseas markets.

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Appendix A-1

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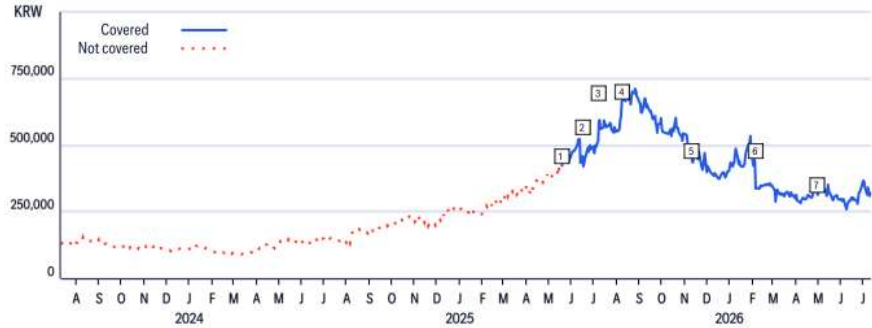
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



1	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	19-May-25 04:55:14	*IH	*560,000.00	422,500.00
2	16-Jun-25 02:31:23	1H	*540,000.00	458,000.00
3	08-Jul-25 10:31:21	*1	*710,000.00	588,000.00

4	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
4	10-Aug-25 17:24:44	1*	*800,000.00	664,000.00
5	11-Nov-25 11:50:03	1	*650,000.00	440,000.00
6	04-Feb-26 11:41:01	1	*570,000.00	439,500.00

7	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
7	30-Apr-26 13:47:42	1	*480,000.00	313,500.00

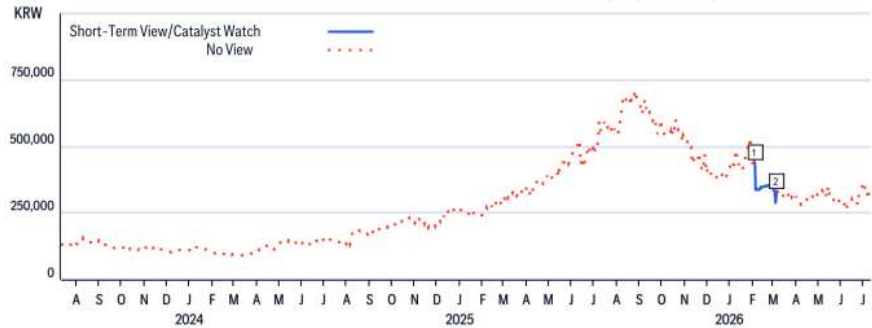
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

PharmaResearch (214450.KQ)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Heejin Lim



1	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	04-Feb-26 06:41:01	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	439,500.00

2	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	06-Mar-26 12:23:25	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	333,000.00

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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Data current as of 01 Jul 2026	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	42%	27%	42%	37%	36%

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Heejin Lim

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